3.1 Presentation

Organizing Professional Presentations:

Spoken words are ephemeral (temporary). But if the presentation has been made using the audio visual aids, it gives lasting effect. Audio visual aids. People vary in their ability to speak confidently in public. When you face an audience you should expect to feel a little nervous. Always prepare more material than required, as this will help you feel confident. Arrange the contents of your presentation into three major parts namely **(1) introduction, (2) middle part and (3) conclusions**. In other words, ***say what you want to say; say it; then say what you have already said.***

- Increase audience interest
- Illustrate key points
- Signal transition from one part of the presentation to the next
- Help listeners retain information
- Help you deliver your speech better
- Organize the visual aids as a part of the presentation
- Emphasize the visual aids
- Talk to the audience not to the visual aids
- Avoid blocking the listener's view of the visual aids
- Do not switch over to other point quickly
- Do not make excessive use of audio visual aids
- Do not use too many lines or figures in one aid
- Make it legible and visible from distance
- Be familiar with basic operation of the electronic devises that you are using

You can conclude the presentation by reviewing the main points. And do give the signal to an end and then do not extend the presentation. Because ***a speech is like a love affair, any fool can start one but to end it requires considerable skill***. Conclude your presentation with quotation, anecdote, a short story, analogy and so on.

After this the presenter can invite the questions for discussion. Make questioners feel that their questions are welcome. Maintain the polite and firm attitude while answering.

Delivery Techniques:

1. Extemporaneous

Extemporaneous presentation is the most popular and effective method. Here rehearsal of presentation to be made is must but cramming must be avoided. It also requires meticulously and well organized content so as to make the presentation more effective.

Advantages

- This gives enough time to prepare the presentation, so work hard on the theme/central idea to present the theme in the best structured way.
- Extemporaneous gives chance to decide the outline of language to be used according to the targeted audience
- The speaker can incorporate appropriate quotations, proverbs, illustrations, and statistics to make his statements authentic.
- Here presentation sounds natural and spontaneous so that speaker can establish rapport with the audience through eye contact.
- It enables one to move freely with ease. **Disadvantages**
- If the preparation is inadequate, the speaker can get lost and find himself uncomfortable.
- If the speaker takes the support of notes or the cards prepared by him, he would lose the spontaneity of flow of ideas

2. Manuscript

In manuscript presentation, material is written and the speaker is supposed to read it ad verbum. You should be wise enough not to attempt to read a speech until you have become proficient reader. Unfortunately most speakers are not good readers. They make it uninteresting by reading in a dull and monotonous way.

For effective use of this mode, you should have gone through the material several times beforehand till you become absolutely familiar with the text. You should know ***what is written where.***

Advantages

- It is a permanent and accurate record of whatever you have to say
- There is no chance of tampering with the facts and figures
- The content can be systematically organized
- Language gets polished

Disadvantages

- Since the speaker is reading from the script, he would not be able to maintain eye contact
- Non verbal communication would have less scope
- Flexibility and adaption is difficult
- In the absence of effective reading skill, you fumble over words, lose your pace, and miss punctuation marks, etc. This adds up to an uninteresting speech and loss of audience attention.

3. Impromptu

The impromptu mode, as the word suggests, is what you use when you have to deliver an informal speech without preparation. For example, at a formal dinner party you may be invited to deliver a vote of thanks. Don't panic and babble something in an unmethodical way. Instead, calmly state your topic and then preview the points you are to make. Be as brief as possible during your impromptu presentations.

Advantages

- The speaker should be natural as he does not get enough time to make any elaborate preparation
- Speaker gets the chance to express his thoughts irrespective of what other think or say

Disadvantages

- The presentation lacks organized development of ideas because of the shortage of time
- There is no supplementary material to substantiate the speech
- The presentation may turn out to be a failure if you have inadequate proficiency in the language to use

Keep in mind that gaining a reputation for being a good impromptu speaker can do a great deal for your career aspirations.

4. Memorization

This method of presentation is very difficult for most of us. Probably a handful of you can actually memorize an entire speech. This type of delivery stands somewhere between extemporaneous and manuscript presentation.

Advantages

- It is easy for speaker to maintain eye contact with audience
- The speaker can easily move and make use of appropriate non verbal communication
- Speech can be completed in time

Disadvantages

- Memorization requires too much of time
- There are chances of making dull presentation
- Flexibility cannot be adopted during the presentation
- The speaker gets flustered if he forgets a word, sentence, or a whole paragraph

Using Presentation Aids: Integrating presentation aids into speeches, Designing effective presentation aids

3.2 Public Speaking

Key Elements of Public Speaking

Element	Description
1. Speaker	The person delivering the message. Credibility and confidence influence how the audience responds.
2. Audience	The listeners. Consider their needs, expectations, and knowledge level when communicating.
3. Message	The main idea you want to share. It must be clear, structured, and easy to understand.
4. Delivery	How you present the message. It includes voice, gestures, pacing, and tone.
5. Feedback	The audience's reaction, which may include questions, expressions, etc.
6. Context	The setting and purpose. It includes the environment and the speaking goal.

1) Mediated public speaking: This refers to any public speaking done through media channels like radio, TV, podcasts, or social media platforms.

Purpose**:** Educate the audience and explain a topic clearly.

Examples**:** Classroom lectures, product presentations, research reports, briefings.

Informative speaking is a popular type of speaking used in professional and academic settings. Its goal is to share knowledge that the audience doesn't already have in a clear, structured way.

You can use it when presenting quarterly results in a business meeting or explaining a new process to your team.

2) Informative speaking: The primary goal is to educate or inform the audience about a specific topic or concept

Purpose**:** Teach the audience how to do something, step by step.

Examples**:** Product demos, how-to tutorials, training sessions, cooking classes.

Many types of public speaking focus on telling, but informative speaking takes it a step further by showing. Basically, it combines explanation with step-by-step guidance, and benefits most from visual aids.

If you've ever watched a tutorial video on how to perform a task, you've seen in action, and you can also deliver yours in a similar format.

3) Persuasive speaking and methods of persuasion: This type of speaking aims to convince the audience to adopt a particular viewpoint or take specific action.

Purpose**:** Convince the audience to take action.

Examples**:** Sales pitches, debates, political speeches, fundraising appeals.

This is a different type of speaking entirely. Persuasive speaking aims not only to convince the audience to take action, but also to accept an idea or opinion.

For example, when presenting a project proposal using slides, your goal is to persuade stakeholders to approve it. That makes persuasive speaking the best choice.

4) Special occasion speaking: This refers to speaking at events like award ceremonies, weddings, and graduation.

Purpose**:** Suit a specific event.

Examples**:** Wedding toasts, graduation speeches, award acceptance speeches, memorial tributes.

For this kind of speaking, there's no single formula because each event has its own emotional weight and audience expectations.

For example, a wedding toast needs warmth and humor, a memorial tribute needs sensitivity and sincerity, an award speech needs gratitude, and so on.

5) Motivational Speaking: The purpose is to inspire and energize the audience to take action.

Purpose**:** Inspire the audience to take action or believe in what's possible.

Examples**:** Keynote speeches, sports coaching talks, and personal development sessions.

Motivational speaking is another speaking skill that bridges storytelling and persuasion. A great motivational speaker doesn't just make the audience feel good; they encourage people to take action.

These speeches often include personal stories, authenticity, and energetic delivery. However, the message should feel genuine and relevant, not like a rehearsed script.

3.3 Interview Skills

An interview is a discussion or conversation between a potential employer and a candidate. It is a selection process designed that helps an employer understand the skills, scrutinise their personality and character traits and check the domain knowledge. In this formal meeting, the employer asks questions to know about a candidate.

Objectives of interviews

1. To select a person
2. To monitor performance
3. To collect information
4. To exchange information
5. To counsel

Types of interviews

Telephonic interview: occur on the phone or via video. An employer conducts such interviews when a candidate cannot attend a face-to-face interview. Rather than calling every candidate for an interview, employers usually conduct phone interviews to screen potential candidates. When candidates receive an unexpected call from employers, they give spontaneous answers that help an employer understand the candidate's intelligence and

Face-to-Face interview: is a common type of interview where one interviewer or a panel interviews a candidate. It is a conversational type of interview where the employer drives the agenda initially and a candidate asks questions toward the end. Usually, an employer may ask general, technical, situational and behavioural questions in a one-to-one interview. It is a great interview technique to understand a candidate's experience and domain knowledge.

- **Campus interviews:** are conducted at the organization site, allowing you to see the physical surroundings. On-campus recruitment events where companies visit universities to find and hire students for internships or full-time positions. To succeed, students should research the company, prepare their resume and common interview questions, dress professionally, practice positive body language, attend mock interviews, and ask insightful questions to showcase their skills and interest

Stages of job interviews

There are four stages of a common interview.

STAGE 1: Introduction

Lasting approximately two to three minutes, you are meeting the interviewers and being escorted to the interview room. It is essential that you start strong, offering a firm handshake, standing confidently, and making good eye contact. Some reports indicate that employers will make their decision to hire a candidate within the first 30 seconds of the interview! Employers may take the time to share information about their organization. Feel free to jot down notes to remember key points for future reference.

STAGE 2: Q&A

The longest portion of the interview, this is when the employer asks you questions and listens to your responses. If the interview is a 30-minute screening interview, this portion is typically about 20 minutes long.

STAGE 3: Your Questions

The employer will ask if you have any questions. This is your chance to demonstrate your knowledge of the organization by asking thoughtful questions. Always come prepared! Bring at least three questions, but also feel free to modify them based on the information you learn during the interview. Be sure to make notes as the interviewer answers your questions.

STAGE 4: Closing

During the last few minutes, take the time to end on a positive note. Reiterate your interest in the position and gather business cards from everyone present. Be sure to thank them for the invitation to interview and offer a firm handshake while making good eye contact.

3.4 Group Discussion

Group Discussion has become an integral part of most selection processes today. Typically, in group discussion, candidates are given a topic or case for discussion. Normally groups of 8 to 10 candidates are formed into a leaderless group and given a specific situation to analyze and discuss with time limit of about 30 minutes.

1. Brainstorming

Brainstorming is a method for generating a variety of ideas and perspectives. A brainstorming session follows the steps given below:

- A group of six to twelve people sit around a table
- The group leader states the problem so that participants can understand it
- Members then suggest alternatives and the views can be noted down
- No criticism is allowed

There are two types of brainstorming technique:

Storyboarding

In storyboarding, participants identify major issues, problems and brainstorm each of them. It is often used to solve complex problems.

Lotus Blossom

In the lotus blossom technique, a core/main thought is presented and participants provide eight ideas surrounding it like the petals of a lotus. Then each of these ideas becomes a core/main thought to be surrounded by another set of eight ideas. And later reach to solution.

In brief, Brainstorming is a process for generating ideas only.

2. Nominal Group Technique

Nominal Group Technique consists of group members who are physically present as it is in traditional committee meeting. They work/operate independently. Here the problem is presented and following steps take place:

- Members meet as a group, but before any discussion takes place, each member independently writes down his or her ideas on the problem.
- Then each member presents his/her idea in turn. No discussion takes place until all ideas have been recorded or noted down.
- The group now discusses the ideas for evaluation.
- Then group members rank the ideas discussed
- The final decision is determined by the idea with the highest aggregate ranking

The main advantage of this technique is that it promotes formal meeting and independent thinking.

3. Delphi Technique

The Delphi Technique is more complex and time consuming. It is similar to Nominal Group Technique but it does not require the physical presence of group members. This technique never allows the group members to meet face to face. The following are the characteristics of Delphi Technique:

- The problem is identified and members are asked to provide potential solutions through series of carefully designed questionnaires
- Each member completes the questionnaire
- The results are compiled and each member receives the copy of results
- The members are again required to offer the criticism.
- The steps may get repeated till consensus is reached

Delphi Technique can be used for decision making in geographically scattered groups. This technique has its drawbacks because the method is extremely time-consuming and frequently

not applicable. Moreover ideas that might be inspired by face to face interaction may never arise.

Group discussions as part of the selection process

Group discussion is an important aspect of the recruitment process especially for management trainees and executive positions.

Group discussion is simulated managerial setting. Most group discussions for selection purposes assess your individual traits, group behavior, and leadership qualities that are needed to succeed in your profession.

Basic Components for Evaluation

1. Knowledge

This refers to the depth and range of your knowledge as well as analytical and organizational abilities. You should be able to grasp the situation and analyze it not just at a mundane level, but from the widest perspective. The greater your knowledge of the subject, the more interested, enthusiastic and confident you will be, and also the more fluent and forceful your contribution will be to the discussion.

2. Communication Skills

During a group discussion, you will be assessed in terms of active listening, clarity of thought and expression, apt language, and appropriateness of body language.

3. Group Behavior (Team Spirit)

Your group behavior is reflected in your ability to interact with other members of the group on brief acquaintance. Emotional maturity and balance promotes good interpersonal relationships. You are expected to be more people centric and less ego centric.

4. Leadership Skills

The success of any team depends, to a large extent, on its leader. Though there is no appointed leader in a group discussion for selection, a leader will emerge as the discussion proceeds. The candidate who possesses both functional ability and coordinating ability will emerge as the leader.

Tips for Success in Group Discussion

- Be thorough with current issues
- Always participate in GD with pen and a piece of paper

- Listen to the topic carefully
- Note down as many ideas as you can in first few minutes
- Try to dissect the topic and explore it
- Organize your ideas before speaking
- Initiate topic if you have something sensible to say
- Try to contribute meaningfully and substantially every time you speak
- Identify your supporters and opponents
- Keep track of time and share time fairly
- Have an open mind set and listen to others' views
- Maintain eye contact
- Do not indulge in parallel conversations
- Use and add sense of humor
- Display the spirit of cooperation and an accommodative nature
- Find out the silent members and encourage them to speak
- If things go chaotic, take the initiative to restore order
- Attempt to arrive at a consensus or conclusion

3.5 Group Communication

Meetings

What is Minutes of Meeting?

It is an official record of the meeting for its participants and a source of information for teammates who were unable to attend. They are meant to be a permanent written record for future references about decisions made. It's often useful as a back-up document.

- What should you include when writing meeting minutes?

To write effective meeting minutes you should include:

Meeting name and place

Date and time of the meeting

List of meeting participants

Purpose of the meeting

For each agenda items: decisions, action items, and next steps

Next meeting date and place

Documents to be included in the meeting report

- Finalizing the meeting minutes

You should wrap-up your notes right after the meeting, while the meeting's still fresh in your mind:

- Complete your meeting notes and clarify points if necessary.
- Double-check that decisions and actions are precisely noted.
- Keep things as concise and digestible as possible.
- Proofread with care. You can use automated grammar checkers such as Grammarly nowadays to help you go faster.
- If needed send the draft to the meeting leader before sharing with other attendees. (Especially for most formal meetings such as "board of directors" or committee meetings.)
- Share the meeting minutes with all meeting attendees and relevant stakeholders. If possible, confirm and read all the necessary points before everybody signs it.

Sample Minutes of Meeting

Government Engineering College, Rajkot
Minutes of the 5th Meeting held on 15/08/25 in Conference Room

Present	Mr. D D Vyas	(Principal)
	Mr. C K Gohel	(HOD-CE/IT)
	Mr. A D Ved	(HOD-EE)
	Mr. P S Puranik	(HOD-MECH)

Following points were discussed and finalized unanimously

- Nearly 20 teachers are required to be appointed in different departments. Preparation work would start by each department
- Examination work would be handled by CE/IT Department and will take help of EE Department
- The MECH Department would prepare a planning to organize the seminar in October

Principal

Conferences

Conference is also a type of discussion or sharing of information. The level of formality of conference varies according to its size and purpose. The purpose of conference is to confer with people having similar interests and to pool their experiences and opinions. Conferences generally result in a set of suggestions or recommendations on the topic or theme of conference. Conference includes formal lectures, exhibitions, and audio video presentations.

Significance/Importance

Conferences play a significant role in developing an analytical and questioning attitude among the participants.

The participants in a conference make an attempt to define the topic in depth, and related factors. They discuss all the factors and offer solutions or suggestions.

Planning and Preparation

Organizing a conference is a challenging task. The following are a few guidelines to help you in planning a conference:

- Decide the theme/topic and related issues
- Decide the date
- Prepare the list of prospective participants
- Identify the chief guest and get his consent
- List out the topics, sessions, chairperson and speakers per session
- Estimate the budget
- Prepare the brochure
- Prepare the covering letter
- Form the various committees & take the follow up
- Prepare the conference evaluation form

Procedure

- Transport
- Accommodation
- Reception
- Timings and duration of sessions
- Identifying volunteers
- Seating
- Projection facilities
- Rapporteuring

- Lunch-tea breaks
- Invitations for inaugural & valedictory functions
- Preparation of souvenir
- Printing of certificates, banners
- Kit selection
- Production of required material
- Venue

Symposia

A symposium is a formal meeting in which exports on a common subject discuss certain topics.

~Select a subject area and a topic
~Divide the topic
~Draft a proposal: objective, theme, topic, issues, dates, duration, names of exports, budget and sponsors
~Send proposal
~Prepare a brochure
~Prepare invitations
~Email participants
~Contact experts
~Identify a person to delivering welcome address
~From committees
~Ensure venue and facilities

A seminar is a meeting held for exchange of useful information. Groups of people come with various information. They present their research to get other's view so participants need to be active. (For preparation and planning refer conference)